

Operational Constraint Definition Module (OCDM)

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Canonical Definition

Operational Constraint Definition Module (OCDM) defines the structural conditions under which autonomous operational constraints are identified, defined, documented, and established before autonomous operations begin.

OCDM governs operational constraint definition.

The module establishes the governance conditions required to ensure that mandatory operational limits are clearly defined before autonomous execution is authorized.

Constraints cannot be enforced until they are defined.

OCDM governs that definition.

Module Operational Role

OCDM defines the operational constraint definition layer of ACS.

Its role is to establish clear, governance-approved operational constraints before autonomous execution begins.

Module Operational Space

OCDM governs:

- operational constraint definition,
- constraint identification,
- operational limit definition,
- governance-approved constraints,
- constraint documentation,
- execution limit definition,
- operational boundary definition,
- governed operational limits.

Module Function

The module applies wherever organizations must define mandatory operational constraints before autonomous systems begin independent operations.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Constraint Object

Identify which operational constraints are required for autonomous execution.

2. Define Constraint Conditions

Establish governance conditions defining mandatory operational, safety, policy, and execution limits.

3. Define Constraint Failure Logic

Identify conditions where constraints are incomplete, ambiguous, inconsistent, or governance-invalid.

4. Define Governance Response

Define governance actions for constraint approval, revision, rejection, or escalation.

5. Preserve Constraint Traceability

Preserve constraint definitions, governance approvals, operational evidence, revision history, and supporting documentation.

Use Case 1 — Autonomous Warehouse Robot

Scenario

A warehouse robot is deployed to transport materials within a production facility.

Application

OCDM defines operational speed limits, permitted operating zones, restricted areas, and safety constraints before execution begins.

Result

The robot operates within clearly established governance-approved operational limits.

Use Case 2 — Autonomous Financial AI Agent

Scenario

An autonomous AI agent performs procurement and financial approval tasks.

Application

OCDM defines transaction limits, approval thresholds, restricted actions, and governance policies before autonomous execution begins.

Result

The organization establishes clear operational constraints that govern every autonomous financial operation.

Canonical Closing Statement

Every governed constraint begins with a clear definition.

Operational Constraint Definition establishes the governance foundation that enables autonomous systems to operate within explicit, approved, and continuously governable operational limits.

Related Documents

→ [Autonomous Constraint Standard \(ACS\)](#).

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Canonical Source

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